Fake Mustache

By Tom Angleberger

LENNY: (Pg 2-3) Don't ever buy a fake mustache at Sven's Fair Price Store in downtown Hairsprinkle. I recommend it if you want to buy fake teeth, fake gum, fake dog poop, or fake people poop. But the fake mustaches are just ***too*** good. Apparently, there are men in Belgium who grow their mustaches for a year, then cut them off and sell them to the Heidelberg Novelty Company. *(beat)* I didn't buy one. My friend Casper Bengue bought one.

CASPER: (Pg 4-5) Look at this, Lenny. My nana Nookums gave me four hundred dollars! I'm going to buy a fake mustache. The Heidelberg Handlebar #7 - $129.00 at Sven's. I'm going to use the rest to get a first-class man-about-town suit.

LENNY: (Pg 7) [So] the first place Casper wanted to go that fateful day was Chauncey's Big & Small, Short & Tall

INTRODUCTION

And that's when things started to turn out bad in a huge, earthshaking, TV-news-special-report kind of way. But don't worry . . . a few days later, our hero -- mild-mannered 7th grader Lenny Flem saved the world!

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(Lenny and Casper enter the store)

RED: (Pg 8-9) Are you boys selling candy bars for your *GottDangled* school? No more candy bars! Get the *Helchfitz* out of here!

CASPER: *(whispering)* Don't worry. When you've got four hundred dollars to spend, you get treated differently. *(Casper fans out the cash and speaks with bravado)* I'd like a man-about-town suit. And I've got cash!

RED: *(Red pulls out a measuring tape and proceeds to measure Casper)* **(Pg 11)** I've got just what you need, sir. The Statesman Deluxe. *(He grabs a suit)* It won't even need tailoring. *(Casper dons the suit and preens in front of the mirror)* A perfect fit. Just $249.99.

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CASPER: Perfect. Even with tax, I'll still have enough left to buy the Heidelberg Handlebar #7. *(the boys exit the store and head to Sven's)*

LENNY: **(Pg 12)** Casper did look a little bit more like a short man-about-town than a slightly tall nerdy seventh grader. *(To Casper)* **(Pg 13)** Why are you holding your hand over your face?

CASPER: *(masking his upper lip with his hand)* There are people who shouldn't see me without the mustache.

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LENNY: **(Pg 16-19)** *(Lenny and Casper enter Sven's)* The manager [of Sven's] turned out to be a very, very angry-looking lady.

SVEN: *(text-messaging, she doesn't even look up)*

CASPER: *(Clearing his throat and speaking in a fake adult voice)* I'm interested in the Heidelberg Handlebar #7.

SVEN: *(Looking Casper up and down, she tosses her cell phone and comes to attention)* I beg your pardon, sir. *(She unlocks a cabinet and punches a code to the alarm) WHOOSH! (the door to the case opens and she removes the mustache as if it were a priceless heirloom)* One formality. The Heidelberg Novelty Company requires me to ask the purpose of your purchase.

CASPER: Our school is putting on a musical adaptation of The Hoboken Chicken Emergency, and I've been chosen to play the mayor.

LENNY: *(aside to the audience)* This was a complete and total lie.

SVEN: Impressive! Here, take a complimentary year's supply of spirit gum. It will keep the mustache on your lip through thick and thin. *(Casper attaches the mustache to his upper lip and the boys exit the shop)*

CASPER: **(Pg 20)** *(to Lenny, while shaking his hand and patting him on the shoulder)* Good-bye, Lenny. Wherever fate leads us, remember that we have walked far in friendship. *(Casper walks away, leaving Lenny with a perplexed look on his face)*

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LENNY: **(Pg 26-27)** The next morning on the Good Morning Hairsprinkle Show.

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REPORTER: This is Giorgio 'Jim' McPunklett, reporting live from Hairsprinkle, where the first-ever billion-dollar bank robbery was carried out by a gang of strolling accordion players. The bank's security cameras caught the robbery on film, and as you can see, the ringleader appears to be a short, well-dressed man-about-town sporting a spectacular handlebar mustache.

LENNY: **(Pg 30)** They closed school. The FBI was worried that the leader of the gang might be dangerous. He had instantly become the 2nd-most wanted criminal in the United States, behind that lady who stole the president's underpants last year. *(pantomime of a lady "pantsing" the president)* *SQUEAL!* Could Casper ***really*** be a bank robber? **(Pg 34)** After supper, I convinced my dad to let me go to Casper's house. *(He was in his room, putting on the suit)*

CASPER: **(Pg 35-38)** How do you like the pinstripes, Lenny?

LENNY: I couldn't think of anything to say, because his bed was piled high with gold bricks and bundles of ten-thousand-dollar bills. *(to Casper)* Did you rob the Federal Gold Reserve? It's all over the news!

CASPER: Huh, well, we don't have a TV, so I didn't see the news. Sorry, I don't have more time to talk. I've got to get to *(grasping for an acceptable location)* School Skate Night down at the roller rink.

LENNY: The roller rink closed last year. Did you do it or not?!?

CASPER: Wish me luck! *(he adjusts his mustache and exits) (Lenny dials 911 on his cell phone)*

RECORDED VOICE: Hairsprinkle Dispatch. The FBI is searching for a short man with a handlebar mustache. Please rat them out at the tone. BEEP

LENNY: I know who the bank robber is. His name is Casper Bengue and he lives at 3414 Sprinkle Street. He's got all this money and gold in his bedroom . . .

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LENNY: **(Pg 40-42)** I worried about it all night. At 5 am I went downstairs and turned on Happy Weekend Hairsprinkle . . .

REPORTER: Hairsprinkle breathes more easily after a quiet night. No more banks have been robbed. We have FBI director Marcie Dropbag with us live from Hairsprinkle. You must be relieved, Director Dropbag.

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DIRECTOR DROPBAG: Frustrated. We spent the evening following up on false tips. Can you believe one caller tried to turn in an actual seventh-grade student. The caller claimed he had a bedroom full of 'money and gold.' We checked it out and found a typical messy bedroom full of smelly clothes, but no gold or money.

REPORTER: Did the 7th grader even ***have*** a mustache, Director Dropbag?

DIRECTOR DROPBAG: Of course not.

LENNY: **(Pg 43)** Outrageous. What ***DID*** happen to all the money Casper had in his room? It was billions of dollars. Where could it have all gone?

REPORTER: In other big news, the Heidelberg Novelty Company has been purchased in a cash transaction for 2.4 billion dollars. The new owner is billionaire businessman Fako Mustacho.

LENNY: And they showed a picture of Casper wearing his mustache! The picture looked exactly like the one of the bank robber they were just talking about. And that name: Fako Mustacho? He was practically spelling it out for them!

REPORTER: **(Pg 44)** I'm sure we'll be hearing a lot more from him in the coming days. The Heidelberg Novelty Company is the world's largest manufacturer of voting machines, and the presidential election is just a few days away.

LENNY: **(Pg 53)** What exactly was Casper – aka the billion-dollar bank robber, aka Fako Mustacho doing? How did he get this power to make ordinary accordion players turn into his henchmen? Brainwashing? Some kind of zombie-mind-power magic? Whatever it was, that mustache must be the key! **(Pg 63-64)** I got on the trolley, and everybody had this weird hypnotized look.

MAN: Have you seen the Evil One?

LADY: If you do, you must capture him and take him to Fako Mustacho. He's a desperate bank-robbing mastermind disguised as a boy named Lenny.

LENNY: **(Pg 64)** I couldn't believe it! Casper had somehow convinced everybody that I was the bad guy! **(Pg 71)**

REPORTER: **(Pg 66)** Heidelberg CEO Fako Mustacho is on his way to address the governor and state lawmakers about the Lenny crisis.

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CASPER: **(Pg 80)** *(waves the legislator off and take his place at the podium, he speaks in a deep voice)* Greetings, my friends! **(Pg 83-85)** I know every piece of evidence points to Lenny Flem being guilty of the string of crimes that has [now] wiped out banks, companies and governments. Every reasonable person believes that Lenny Flem is guilty.

CROWD: *(chanting as a hypnotized collective)* Evil One . . Evil One . . Evil One . .

CASPER: But not I. In this great country no one is truly guilty until they have been convicted in a court of law. Now, the governor is a close friend of mine. However, she hasn't been able to catch Lenny Flem. *(to Governor)* Would you mind resigning?

GOVERNOR: *(in a hypnotized manger, she takes the microphone)* I hereby resign as governor . .

CROWD: Quit hogging the mic! Let Fako talk!

LENNY: So, Fako was appointed governor by a unanimous vote. Now it wasn't just my word against his; it would be my word against the governor's! **(Pg 111)** Fake Mustacho seemed to have taken over the whole town. No, the whole state!

CROWD: *CHEERING*

LENNY: *TRANSITION ADDED:* [That's when I knew I had to break into Governor Mustacho's office] **(Pg 107-108)** I looked at a few of the papers on the desk: **INAUGURATION PLANNING** was written on one folder. *(he leafs through the folder; an astonished look appears on his face)* And then I understood. It wasn't about his swearing in as governor, it was about his swearing in as the President of the United States of America! He bought the Heidelberg Novelty Company, but not for the mustaches – it was for the ***voting machines***.

REPORTER: *(echoing voice)* **(Pg 44)** The Heidelberg Novelty Company is the world's largest manufacturer of voting machines

LENNY: **(Pg 108)** Election Day was three days away. And somehow Fako Mustacho was going to get himself elected president!

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REPORTER: **(Pg 166-168)** Let's take a look at our electoral map. It shows that Fako Mustacho has received 100% of the vote so far.

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REPORTER 2: Truly amazing. Just a few weeks ago no one had even heard of Fako Mustacho. We all thought that a Republican or a Democrat would win . . .

REPORTER: We were fools back then. We, the people, have seen the light.

CROWD: **(Pg 171)** FAKO FAKO FAKO FAKO

******* [a few days later] ********

CASPER: **(Pg 171-173)** *(entering his office)* Well, that's that. I'm the next president of the USA!

LENNY: You stole their votes!

CASPER: *(smirking)* Look, it's over. I won. All I have to do is say the word and the CIA ships you off to Antarctica with all the other wackos who are a danger to this fine country. But I'm going to give you another option . . . Admit that I'm the new president and I'll let you walk out the door. I'll make my speech and tell everyone that you're not the Evil One, Lenny. No one will ever bother you again. *(Lenny opens his mouth to say something but Casper cuts him off)* I can't tolerate treason or threats against our democratic process. If you say anything other than 'OK, Mr. President,' you'll be silenced and taken away and that will be it.

LENNY: *(with complete sarcasm)* OK . . . Mr. President.

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REPORTER: **(Pg 185)** And now let's go live to Fako Mustacho's victory speech . . . *(Casper takes the stage in a grandiose manner waving and pumping his fist in victory)*

STRANGE MAN: **(Pg 56)** *(bursts in yelling in a European accent)* Where is the Heidelberg Handlebar #7!

DR. HEIDELBERG: *(echoing voice from the past)* **(Pg 101, 103)** 72 years ago, my brother, Tito made the Heidelberg Handlebar #7. It was woven from the hairs of a very bad man who gave up his mustache unwillingly.

STRANGE MAN: **(Pg 56)** I am here to retrieve what belongs to me and only me! Even if it means spilling the blood of another! *(He whips out a weapon)*

DR. HEIDELBERG: *(echoing voice from the past)* **(Pg 103-104)** He was a professional assassin, famous in the European underworld for his record of 300 kills and his perfect mustache. He was betrayed by a woman and arrested. When he arrived at prison, they shaved his mustache.

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[And now] the Heidelberg Handlebar #7 is too powerful, especially if it falls into the wrong hands.

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LENNY: **(Pg 186)** Here's what happened . . . I have a glimpse of Fako standing on the stage with his arms raised. *(Casper and Lenny pantomimes the events while Lenny narrates)* The French guy is squeezing the trigger . . . **(Pg 188-189)** and I am in motion . . . I land on the stage, grab the mustache, put it between my teeth and rip it in two. The mustache is dead! **(Pg 191)** And the platoon of Secret Service agents that rushed the stage found only two local Hairsprinkle schoolkids. No one saw what happened to Fako . . . and no one ever saw him again.

(Pg 2) I saved the world and it all started with me and my friend Casper going to Sven's Fair Price Store in downtown Hairsprinkle. *(stage whisper)* Don't ever buy a fake mustache at Sven's!

SOURCE INFORMATION

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